

KSA Compliance Roadmap

SECTION 04-compliance-ksa TYPE plan STATUS draft OWNER Founder UPDATED 2026-07-03

Status: draft (sequenced) · Created: 2026-06-16 · Rewritten: 2026-07-03 · Owner: Founder

Not legal or regulatory advice, and not a statement of certified compliance status. Statuses below are the founder's operational tracking, sequenced against `../00-strategy/ceo-execution-roadmap-2026-07.md` (Sprints 0–3) and `../02-legal/launch-gate-legal-checklist-2026-06-14.md` (gates L0–L3). Every filing must be confirmed against the relevant Saudi authority before reliance. Items marked **[Owner to confirm]** are open unknowns.

Purpose

A diffable index and status tracker over the KSA regulatory pack — what each filing is, who owns it, its current state, and what gates it blocks. The binding detail lives in the `.docx` deliverables listed below. Company context: solo founder, **pre-entity (no CR yet), pre-revenue**; the first revenue motion is B2B school pilots invoiced manually (ZATCA-compliant e-invoice) per DEC-009.

The dependency chain (from the CEO execution roadmap)

Lawyer opinion → NAME LOCKED → CR → Bank account → ZATCA VAT + Fatoora → Payment gateway → Paywall flip (L2)
Parallel: PDPL DPIA specialist review → public user accounts (L1)
Parallel: B2B pilot → manual ZATCA e-invoice → first revenue (pre-Fatoora-onboarding)

Hard deadline: 12 Aug 2026 — the new Saudi Copyright Law + SAIP implementing regulations take effect; the lawyer opinion (Sprint 0/1) must account for it.

Registrations & licensing

Item	Deliverable	Owner	Status	Blocks
Commercial Registration (CR)	Saudi Business Center filing — result logged in <code>../00-strategy/phase0.md</code> (P0-3)	Founder	Blocked-by-name-lock (lawyer opinion, Sprint 1) — target Sprint 2 (2026-07-30 → 08-27). Sole-prop vs LLC choice open [Owner to confirm]	Bank account → ZATCA VAT → payment gateway → paywall flip (L2); Monshaat; NTDP; entity-name contracts

Item	Deliverable	Owner	Status	Blocks
MISA investment license	misa-investment-license-application-bundle.docx	Founder	Not started — [Owner to confirm] whether MISA is required at all for a Saudi-national solo founder (the CEO roadmap routes entity formation via CR on the Saudi Business Center, not MISA)	Nothing on the Q3 critical path if not required
Monshaat SME registration	monshaat-sme-registration-kit.docx	Founder	Not started — Blocked-by-CR (Sprint 2.2)	SME support programs only; nothing downstream
NTDP application	ntdp-application.docx	Founder	Not started — Blocked-by-CR ; eligibility check scheduled Sprint 2.2	Grant/support funding only
Tamheer & Doroob	tamheer-and-doroob-program-application-pack.docx	Founder	Not started — not applicable pre-entity and pre-hire; no hires planned this quarter	First-hire onboarding only

Tax & invoicing

Item	Deliverable	Owner	Status	Blocks
VAT compliance	vat-compliance-memo.docx	Founder	Memo drafted; registration Not started — Blocked-by-CR + bank account (Sprint 3.1)	Fatoora onboarding; consumer checkout (L2)
ZATCA Fatoora e-invoicing	zatca-fatoora-e-invoicing-compliance-pack.docx	Founder	Pack drafted, not implemented. Interim: first B2B pilot invoice is issued as a manual ZATCA-compliant e-invoice (Sprint 2.5, per ../07-gtm/b2b-pipeline.md). Full Fatoora onboarding is Sprint 3.1, Blocked-by-VAT-registration	First B2B revenue (manual path); paywall flip (integrated path)
Tax/compliance calendar	saudi-tax-and-compliance-calendar.docx	Founder	Drafted — activates as an operational tracker on CR issuance	Nothing; tracking aid

Workforce

Item	Deliverable	Owner	Status	Blocks
Saudization (Nitaqat)	saudization-nitaqat-compliance-plan.docx	Founder	Plan drafted; not applicable pre-entity / pre-first-employee . Revisit at first hire (likeliest: paid help on ZATCA/payments integration or Arabic legal-page review, per CEO roadmap risk checkpoints)	Nothing until first employee

Data protection & security

Item	Deliverable	Owner	Status	Blocks
PDPL program & DPIA	pdpl-compliance-program-and-dpia.docx	Founder	In progress — internally drafted and founder-signed; awaiting PDPL-specialist / SDAIA-qualified counsel review (parallel track, Sprint 2.4; checklist item P0-6/L-3)	Public user accounts (L1); AI features for account holders. Does not block the B2B pilot motion
Information security	information-security-policy.docx	Founder	Drafted (ISO 27001 / CITC-aligned)	B2B security questionnaires; institutional customers
Sub-processors / DPA register	sub-processor-list-and-dpa-register.docx	Founder	Partial — review needed (confirm Cloudflare Web Analytics and the payment processor are listed; checklist P1-7). Payment processor entry pending Stripe-vs-Moyasar reconciliation (decision-log open item) [Owner to confirm]	Accounts launch (L1); every signed B2B DPA (../02-legal/b2b-data-processing-agreement-draft-2026-06-14.md Part 5 references this register)
Vendor management	vendor-management-policy.docx	Founder	Drafted	—
Business continuity / DR	business-continuity-and-disaster-recovery-plan-bcp-dr.docx	Founder	Drafted	Institutional B2B due diligence only

Launch gates

Cross-reference [../02-legal/launch-gate-legal-checklist-2026-06-14.md](#) :

Gate	Event	Hard compliance gates from this roadmap
L0 — soft open (free library)	Public access, no accounts	None from this pack (legal-track items P0-1...P0-5 gate L0)
L1 — accounts launch	Registration, free tier	PDPL DPIA specialist sign-off ; sub-processor register current
L2 — payments launch	Paid subscriptions online	CR → bank → ZATCA VAT → Fatoora → payment gateway — the full chain above
L3 — Academy B2B (contracted)	Signed school deals	Manual ZATCA e-invoice capability (available pre-L2); signed DPA per customer

Monetization gate (per `../03-finance/monetization.md`): online checkout cannot open until the legal entity exists; B2B schools can be quoted and manually invoiced first.

Sequenced narrative

Q3 2026 (now — the critical-path quarter)

- **Sprint 0, wk of 2026-07-02**: lawyer brief out to 2–3 shortlisted firms (DEC-007). No compliance filings possible yet — everything registration-shaped is gated on the name.
- **Sprint 1, to 07-30**: engage one firm; receive the written opinion (corpus rights + name, accounting for the **12 Aug 2026** copyright law); **lock the name** (DEC-008).
- **Sprint 2, 07-30 → 08-27**: register the **CR** (sole-prop vs LLC decided first); open the **bank account**; submit **Monshaat** and check **NTDP** eligibility; complete the **PDPL DPIA** review in parallel; issue the **first manual ZATCA e-invoice** against a converted school pilot.
- **Sprint 3, 08-27 → 09-24**: **ZATCA VAT registration + Fatoora onboarding**; payment gateway live (Stripe-vs-Moyasar to be reconciled first — decision-log open item); paywall flip.

Q4 2026 (post-entity consolidation)

- Fatoora issuing on every transaction; tax/compliance calendar live against real filing dates; first VAT return cycle.
- Arabic versions of P0/P1 legal documents (counsel to confirm if legally required — checklist L-4); SAIP trademark application (post name opinion, checklist L-5).
- Sub-processor register finalized against the chosen payment processor.
- Saudization/Tamheer revisited only if the first hire happens.

2027 (growth-stage items)

- External PDPL audit by a certified KSA privacy consultant (after 3+ months of account data); NCA Essential Cybersecurity Controls alignment; penetration test before institutional/government academy customers. (Checklist Table 7.)

Data-residency note

PDPL target region is **me-central2 (Dammam, Saudi Arabia)**; interim compute runs in **me-central1 (Doha, Qatar)** — see `../06-operations-it/repo-health-report-2026-06-16.md` §2.1 and `../06-operations-it/runbooks/runbook-pdpl-me-central2.md`.

Open questions

- **[Owner to confirm]** Is a MISA license required at all for a Saudi-national solo founder, or is CR-via-Saudi-Business-Center the complete entity path?
- **[Owner to confirm]** Sole proprietorship vs LLC for the CR (Sprint 2.1 prerequisite).
- **[Owner to confirm]** Stripe vs Moyasar as the live processor (decision-log DEC-003 vs built Stripe checkout) — affects the sub-processor register and Fatoora integration.
- **[Owner to confirm]** VAT registration threshold/timing: mandatory vs voluntary registration point for the expected first-year revenue (~SAR 125k B2B ARR logic).
- **[Owner to confirm]** me-central2 migration date (Google access grant) — the PDPL posture for account-stage data depends on it.

Living doc — bump statuses each sprint. Companion to `../00-strategy/ceo-execution-roadmap-2026-07.md` and `../02-legal/launch-gate-legal-checklist-2026-06-14.md`.